

Sara Costa

Founder & Cloud Security Consultant

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Professional Summary

Cloud security consultant with 7+ years of experience across AWS, Azure, and GCP. Founder of Papaya Kiwi Consulting LLC, focused on practical remediation, infrastructure-as-code, and security enablement. Active Secret clearance with service in the U.S. Army Reserves.

Experience

Papaya Kiwi Consulting LLC

Nov 2025 – Present

Founder & Cloud Security Consultant

- Lead cloud security engagements covering Kubernetes, container hardening, and remediation automation.
- Design technical learning labs and practical security content for engineering teams.
- Bridge security and business stakeholders through clear, implementation-ready guidance.

Private Subcontractor (Professional Services for PANW)

Aug 2024 – Oct 2025

Cloud Security Consultant

- Primary SME for cloud posture and data security posture in Prisma Cloud across AWS, Azure, and GCP.
- Automated alerting and remediation workflows using Terraform and Python.
- Designed security tabletop exercises to improve cloud incident response maturity.

BxC Security

Sept 2022 – Feb 2024

Security Consultant

- Delivered cloud threat identification and remediation programs for enterprise environments.
- Conducted PAM-related vulnerability gap assessments and authored executive technical documentation.
- Designed and implemented corporate PKI architecture.

US Army Reserves

Jul 2021 – Present

25/35 Series MOS Specialist

- Provided technical support in classified and unclassified environments.
- Configured and maintained secure communications and NIPR network infrastructure.

BENTELER Group

Mar 2019 – Jun 2020

Software Developer / Data Scientist

- Developed IoT and analytics workflows using SQL, Python, Java, and KNIME.
- Built KPI dashboards and supported full-cycle software delivery in manufacturing operations.

Education

University of Maryland Global Campus

2023 – 2024

M.S., Computer and Information Systems Security

LSU Shreveport

2017 – 2019

B.S., Computer and Information Systems Security

Certifications

CompTIA Security+ ce

Active Secret Clearance (TS investigation in progress)

Patent Pending: USPTO #64/022,497

Speaking / Projects

BSides South Florida (May 2026): From Prompt to Pipeline

Presented a dual-agent remediation method that transforms natural language security requests into validated workflows for cloud remediation.

Pipeline Demos (Open Source)

Security workflow demonstration project illustrating scanner validation and infrastructure-as-code remediation patterns.